

Functional Erasure - A Documentary and Forensic Analysis of the Institutional Invisibility of a Living Person

Abstract

This paper examines the proposition that a living person may become functionally invisible to the institutions and social structures responsible for recognising, protecting and responding to them while remaining physically alive, legally identifiable and continuously documented. Drawing upon the publicly identified Barran Dodger documentary repositories as the principal documentary corpus, the paper develops a forensic framework for analysing the alleged transformation of a person from an independently functioning social subject into a sequence of institutional categories—patient, client, complainant, service user, financial-management matter, legal matter, or other administratively bounded identity. The analysis distinguishes documentary fact from corroborated claim, documented allegation, inference and unresolved hypothesis. It considers potential mechanisms including institutional fragmentation, credibility degradation, disability and mental-health classification, procedural exhaustion, economic dependency, service dependency, accommodation vulnerability, social isolation, referral loops, omission, institutional self-protection, potential retaliation, prejudice and possible conflicts of interest. Particular attention is given to the distinction between evidence that demonstrates the occurrence of an event and evidence that establishes causation, motive, coordination or criminality. The paper argues that the principal forensic significance of the archive is not that the existence of a repository proves every allegation contained within it, but that preservation makes it possible to reconstruct the chronology across otherwise fragmented institutional systems. Survival itself changes the evidentiary problem: the person who describes having been rendered socially and institutionally invisible remains alive and has preserved a documentary record capable of independent examination. The paper therefore proposes that the appropriate next stage is not assumption of guilt or innocence but systematic reconstruction of the documentary chronology, institutional knowledge, decision-making authority, omissions, consequences, contradictions and alternative explanations contained within the corpus.

Keywords: functional erasure, institutional invisibility, documentary evidence, whistleblowing, disability, administrative justice, institutional failure, social exclusion, archival preservation, credibility, procedural exhaustion, Australia

Introduction

Modern administrative societies recognise individuals through institutions. A person is not encountered by government, healthcare, disability services, police, courts, employers, financial administrators and oversight bodies as a complete human being simultaneously. Instead, the individual is divided among systems. One institution possesses a medical record; another possesses an employment record; another possesses a financial record; another possesses a complaint; another possesses a service agreement; another possesses a legal file. The individual experiences these matters as one continuous life, while institutions frequently experience them as separate administrative objects.

This paper examines what happens when that fragmentation becomes sufficiently severe that a person remains physically alive but becomes functionally absent from the systems upon which their welfare, credibility, autonomy and protection depend. The term functional erasure is used here analytically rather than literally. It does not necessarily mean that a person's legal identity was deleted, that records ceased to exist, or that a centrally coordinated conspiracy has been established. It describes the possible condition in which a person remains alive and identifiable while progressively losing meaningful recognition as a whole human subject whose circumstances require substantive institutional response.

The distinction is important because the documentary proposition under examination is not simply that harm occurred. It is that a pattern of institutional interactions may have transformed the person from an individual with a professional, social and personal identity into a series of administratively bounded problems. The archive therefore raises a question that is broader than any individual complaint: how can a person remain present in thousands of institutional records while becoming absent from the decision-making structures that determine whether anyone meaningfully responds to the totality of their circumstances?

The principal public documentary starting point is the [Barrandodger GitHub repository](#), accompanied by the [Barran Dodger PDF archive](#), the [Barrandodger rebuild repository](#), and the author's [complete GitHub repository index](#). These repositories constitute a preservation and publication architecture through which the author seeks to make a large documentary corpus available for examination.

The methodological distinction between an archive and an adjudication is fundamental. A repository can preserve an allegation without establishing its truth. It can preserve a government letter without establishing that the government's account is correct. It can preserve a person's testimony without establishing the truth of every proposition contained within that testimony. Conversely, preservation can prevent a document, chronology or allegation from simply disappearing from public view. The evidentiary

task is therefore to determine what each document establishes, what it corroborates, what it alleges, what can reasonably be inferred from it, and what remains unresolved.

Documentary Corpus and Method

The Barran Dodger repositories should be understood as a distributed documentary corpus rather than as a single webpage. The [main repository](#) contains documentary, evidentiary and archival material intended to preserve a chronology and provide access to underlying records. The [PDF repository](#) provides a separate preservation layer, while the [rebuild repository](#) represents another public presentation of the archive. The author's [GitHub repository directory](#) provides the wider repository context.

This structure is significant because the forensic value of a documentary archive depends upon provenance, preservation and reproducibility. GitHub's own documentation confirms that repositories can be downloaded as snapshots and, importantly, that commit-specific archives can provide reproducible file contents associated with a particular commit. This creates a potential methodological pathway for preserving and analysing a repository independently of the limitations of GitHub's webpage rendering.

The wider field of digital preservation provides a comparable methodological principle. ArchiveBox, for example, describes an archival system capable of preserving webpages and linked materials in multiple durable formats, including HTML, PDF, screenshots, text, JSON and WARC, and explicitly identifies legal-evidence preservation as one potential application. Such preservation does not itself establish the truth of archived material; rather, it preserves the material so that its contents, provenance and chronology can subsequently be examined.

The appropriate analytical model for the Barran Dodger corpus is therefore:

source document → provenance → date → actors → institutional context → event → response → consequence → corroboration → contradiction → evidentiary classification.

This approach avoids a common error in documentary research: treating the quantity of documents as equivalent to proof. Ten thousand allegations are not necessarily stronger than one independently verified document. Conversely, a large corpus may reveal patterns that cannot be identified from an isolated document. The relevant unit of analysis is therefore both the individual document and the pattern formed by documents across time.

From Social Identity to Administrative Identity

The first potential mechanism of functional erasure is the transformation of identity.

Individuals possess complex identities. They may simultaneously be professionals, parents, researchers, artists, journalists, citizens, patients, tenants, disability-service participants, advocates, complainants and witnesses. Administrative systems cannot practically process all dimensions of a person's life at once. They therefore reduce the person to categories.

Categorisation is not inherently abusive. It is an ordinary requirement of administration. The problem arises when the administrative category becomes the dominant representation of the person.

A former professional can become "client." A person reporting misconduct can become "complainant." A person repeatedly seeking assistance can become "high-frequency correspondent." A person receiving psychiatric treatment can become "mental-health patient." A person dependent upon disability support can become "participant." A person disputing an administrative decision can become "difficult" or "unreasonable."

Once the category becomes more institutionally salient than the underlying history, the person risks losing contextual recognition.

The resulting mechanism can be expressed as:

complex human identity → administrative classification → institutional shorthand → reduced contextual understanding → functional invisibility.

The forensic question is not whether classification occurred. Classification inevitably occurs. The question is whether the classifications documented in the corpus progressively displaced consideration of the underlying facts.

Credibility and the Transformation of the Complainant into the Problem

A second mechanism is credibility degradation.

Institutions necessarily evaluate information. They must determine whether claims are supported, whether records are authentic, whether allegations fall within jurisdiction and whether action is justified. The danger arises when the identity of the person making the allegation begins to substitute for examination of the allegation itself.

A complainant may initially be understood through the substance of a complaint. Over time, however, the institutional record may increasingly focus on the person's manner of communication, frequency of correspondence, emotional state or prior history.

This creates a potential feedback loop:

harm → complaint → insufficient response → repeated complaint → characterisation of complaint as excessive → credibility reduction → further insufficient response.

The significance of this hypothesis is that the person's attempts to obtain recognition can become evidence used to diminish recognition.

The forensic analysis should therefore compare early and later institutional language. Did the focus remain on the substance of the allegations, or did it shift toward the character, mental state, communication style or reputation of the complainant? Did the institution investigate the underlying allegation independently of the complainant's presentation? Were competing explanations considered?

These questions are testable through contemporaneous documents.

Disability, Mental Health and the Risk of Credibility Substitution

The corpus includes extensive material concerning disability, healthcare, mental-health treatment and support services. These records require particular caution because the existence of mental-health or disability information does not establish either reliability or unreliability.

A diagnosis is not a credibility finding.

The forensic question is whether institutional knowledge of disability or mental-health history altered subsequent treatment.

A rigorous analysis would therefore examine whether there were temporal changes in institutional language or behaviour after disclosure of such information. Relevant

indicators would include changes in the willingness to investigate allegations, assumptions about capacity, refusal or provision of accommodations, treatment of testimony, responses to complaints, or explanations offered for adverse decisions.

If the documentary record showed that an allegation was initially treated as an ordinary administrative matter but subsequently reclassified primarily as a manifestation of the complainant's health status, that would constitute evidence relevant to a hypothesis of credibility substitution.

Such evidence would still require contextual analysis. A change in classification could have legitimate reasons. The forensic question is whether the explanation offered is supported by the record and whether similarly situated persons were treated consistently.

Fragmentation Across Institutions

The strongest structural explanation for functional invisibility may be institutional fragmentation.

A person experiences one continuous chronology. Institutions possess separate files.

A medical institution may know about a health event but not a financial problem. A financial administrator may know about financial dependency but not the underlying service dispute. A disability provider may know about accommodation problems but not the person's legal history. Police may receive an allegation without possessing the documentary context. An oversight agency may receive a complaint without the records held by the agency being complained about.

This creates what may be called the fragmented-subject problem.

The person is the only entity that experiences the entire sequence simultaneously.

Consequently, each institution may possess enough information to respond to its own narrow question while no institution possesses or assumes responsibility for the whole.

The consequence can be severe:

the more fragmented the person becomes institutionally, the harder it becomes for any individual institution to understand the cumulative pattern.

This does not require collusion.

It can emerge from ordinary organisational structure.

That distinction is central to the analysis.

Referral Loops and the Distribution of Responsibility

A particularly important form of fragmentation is the referral loop.

The individual approaches one organisation. The organisation identifies another body as responsible. The second organisation identifies a third. The third identifies a jurisdictional limitation. The person returns to the first.

The resulting system can be represented as:

$A \rightarrow B \rightarrow C \rightarrow A$

From the perspective of each organisation, a reasonable procedural explanation may exist.

From the perspective of the individual, however, the result is that nobody accepts responsibility for the complete problem.

The forensic task is therefore to identify every referral within the documentary corpus and determine whether the receiving organisation actually assumed responsibility.

A referral should not automatically be counted as an intervention.

The relevant distinction is between:

referral

and

resolution.

A person may be referred repeatedly while receiving no substantive remedy.

Procedural Exhaustion and the Practical Accessibility of Rights

A person can possess formal rights without possessing practical access to those rights.

Legal systems may require applications, evidence, deadlines, standing and representation. Administrative systems may require forms, specific jurisdiction and procedural compliance. Oversight systems may impose statutory limitations. Disability systems may impose eligibility and review processes.

Each requirement may appear reasonable independently.

Their cumulative effect may nevertheless become overwhelming for a person who is simultaneously experiencing financial, medical, social or accommodation instability.

The relevant research question therefore becomes:

Was the remedy formally available, and was it practically accessible to the person under the documented circumstances?

This distinction is especially significant where the corpus records repeated attempts to obtain legal assistance, oversight or independent investigation.

Procedural activity should not automatically be confused with substantive justice.

A file can be opened, closed, referred and answered without the underlying factual question ever being independently examined.

Economic Dependency and the Loss of Institutional Bargaining Power

Economic independence determines how effectively an individual can resist institutional decisions.

A financially secure person may retain counsel, commission experts, obtain independent accommodation, travel, seek alternative services or simply withstand delays.

A financially dependent person may not.

Economic dependency can therefore amplify every other institutional vulnerability.

The documentary material concerning financial administration, government payments and resource access should consequently be examined alongside the chronology of complaints and requests for intervention.

The appropriate question is not simply whether a particular payment was made or missed. It is whether control over essential resources altered the person's capacity to challenge institutions, obtain alternatives or maintain basic security at critical points in the chronology.

If financial vulnerability coincided with institutional conflict, the relationship between the two requires examination.

Correlation would not itself prove intentional financial coercion.

But it would establish a significant contextual factor.

Service Dependency and Accommodation

The same structural problem arises within disability services and supported accommodation.

A person dependent upon a provider may require that provider for essential daily support.

That creates a power asymmetry.

The individual may need the service while simultaneously needing to complain about it.

This produces the dependency paradox:

The person must challenge the organisation while remaining dependent upon the organisation.

The documentary corpus concerning accommodation, support workers, providers, assistance animals and requests for intervention should therefore be analysed not

merely as a series of individual disputes but as evidence concerning the individual's practical ability to exit, challenge or obtain independent assistance.

The relevant questions include whether alternative accommodation existed, whether independent advocacy was available, whether complaints affected service provision, whether agreements were documented, whether warnings were acted upon, and whether the person was able to obtain assistance without jeopardising essential services.

Social Isolation and Network Collapse

Institutional erasure can become more powerful when professional, financial and social losses accumulate.

Loss of employment can produce loss of income.

Loss of income can produce dependency.

Dependency can reduce bargaining power.

Conflict with service providers can produce further institutional classification.

Institutional classification can influence social relationships.

Social isolation can increase dependency.

The process therefore becomes recursive:

loss → dependency → conflict → classification → isolation → greater dependency.

This is not necessarily evidence of deliberate targeting.

It is a mechanism through which independently generated institutional decisions can converge upon the same person.

The central empirical question is whether the chronology demonstrates such convergence.

Mobbing, Social Conformity and Distributed Responsibility

The corpus contains material specifically framed around mobbing and the safety of the crowd. Such material raises a question about distributed social responsibility.

A group does not necessarily require a formal conspiracy to produce exclusion.

People can reinforce one another's assumptions.

One institution may accept another's characterisation. A professional may rely on an earlier assessment. A service provider may rely on another agency's description. A colleague may avoid involvement because others have already characterised the person as problematic.

The result can be institutional conformity.

This is distinct from conspiracy.

The forensic investigation must therefore distinguish between:

- 1. deliberate coordination;**
- 2. informal communication;**
- 3. institutional imitation;**
- 4. shared assumptions;**
- 5. independent decisions producing the same result.**

Only the documentary evidence can establish which explanation is best supported.

Omission and the Problem of Institutional Non-Response

The absence of an action can be as significant as the presence of one, but only under carefully defined conditions.

A non-response becomes forensically meaningful when an institution:

- received information;**
- possessed relevant authority;**
- had an identifiable opportunity to act;**
- understood or should reasonably have understood the significance;**

- and nevertheless failed to undertake an appropriate response.

This creates a five-part evidentiary test:

knowledge + authority + opportunity + foreseeable consequence + response.

The absence of intervention should therefore never be described simply as “complicity” without first establishing these elements.

The corpus’s references to deliberate omission provide a hypothesis for investigation, not a substitute for that investigation.

Prejudice and Discrimination

The possibility of prejudice should be evaluated through patterns and comparators.

Evidence relevant to prejudice could include differential treatment of similarly situated individuals, stereotyping, disability-based assumptions, unequal access to procedural opportunities, differential responsiveness, refusal of reasonable accommodation, or unexplained changes in treatment following disclosure of protected characteristics.

A single adverse decision does not establish discrimination.

A pattern can be considerably more probative.

The strongest form of evidence would involve a comparator:

similar circumstances + different person + materially different institutional treatment.

The corpus should therefore be analysed not only internally but comparatively wherever comparable institutional decisions can be identified.

Retaliation and Temporal Association

Retaliation can similarly be examined through chronology.

If an individual makes a complaint, disclosure or protected report and subsequently

experiences an adverse action, the sequence may justify investigation.

It does not automatically establish retaliation.

The evidence must answer:

What happened first?

Who knew?

What changed afterward?

Who made the subsequent decision?

Was the decision independently justified?

Were similarly situated people treated differently?

Was there communication linking the complaint to the subsequent action?

Temporal association is therefore an investigative signal rather than proof.

Financial Relationships and the Bribery Hypothesis

The user's documentary corpus raises, among other allegations, questions concerning financial relationships and possible improper influence. These questions require the highest level of evidentiary restraint.

A payment does not establish bribery.

A contract does not establish bribery.

A salary does not establish bribery.

Government expenditure does not establish bribery.

To establish bribery, the documentary record would need to connect a benefit or payment to an improper inducement or exchange.

The evidentiary sequence would need to approach:

benefit → recipient → purpose → inducement → improper act → connection.

Accordingly, financial records should be treated as evidence requiring examination rather than interpreted automatically as proof of corruption.

If the corpus contains invoices, contracts, bank records, procurement material, messages or communications that establish such a connection, those records should be separately identified and independently verified.

If they do not, bribery must remain an unresolved hypothesis.

This methodological distinction is not a weakening of the archive. It is necessary to preserve its credibility.

Institutional Self-Protection as a Possible Motive

Institutions possess incentives that can produce defensive behaviour without requiring criminal intent.

These may include avoiding:

- **liability;**
- **reputational damage;**
- **adverse publicity;**
- **precedent;**
- **litigation;**
- **criticism of employees;**
- **regulatory scrutiny;**
- **admission of error;**
- **or increased workload.**

If several institutions repeatedly behave in ways that minimise their own exposure while leaving the underlying problem unresolved, institutional self-protection becomes a plausible hypothesis.

Again, however, motive must be inferred from evidence.

The relevant records would include changes in institutional language, internal

communications, decision-making sequences, legal advice, escalation patterns and explanations for non-action.

The Difference Between Conspiracy and Systemic Failure

The documentary pattern should not prematurely be interpreted as a single conspiracy.

There are at least four competing explanations.

The first is distributed institutional failure, in which independent organisations repeatedly fail to understand the whole situation.

The second is systemic discrimination, in which structural assumptions produce consistently adverse outcomes.

The third is retaliation or organisational self-protection, in which institutions respond defensively to complaints or disclosures.

The fourth is deliberate coordination, in which actors consciously collaborate.

A fifth possibility is a combination of these.

The forensic purpose of the corpus is therefore not to assume which explanation is correct but to discriminate between them.

The Temporal Problem: When Did Functional Erasure Occur?

Functional erasure should not necessarily be assigned to a single date.

It is more appropriately understood as a process.

A potential chronology is:

recognition → disruption → classification → conflict → credibility degradation → dependency → fragmentation → procedural exhaustion → social isolation → functional invisibility → independent preservation → survival.

Each transition requires evidence.

The critical methodological question is therefore not:

“When was Barran Dodger erased?”

but:

“At what points in the documentary chronology did the individual’s institutional status, credibility, autonomy, resources and access to protection materially deteriorate?”

That formulation permits evidence to determine the answer.

The Archive as a Counter-Mechanism to Erasure

The preservation architecture reverses one of the central mechanisms of institutional disappearance.

Erasure requires forgetting.

Archiving produces memory.

Fragmentation produces disconnected records.

Archiving creates chronology.

Institutional ownership produces asymmetry.

Independent preservation creates an alternative evidentiary record.

The existence of a public repository therefore has significance beyond publication. It constitutes an attempt to prevent the documentary record from becoming dependent upon the continued willingness of any one institution to preserve, explain or acknowledge it.

This is consistent with broader digital-preservation practice. ArchiveBox, for example, preserves web material in multiple standard formats and can preserve GitHub/GitLab sources alongside associated documentation and metadata.

The preservation of evidence does not establish the truth of the preserved proposition. It establishes something different but important:

the proposition remains available for examination.

Survival and the Transformation of the Evidentiary Position

Survival changes the nature of the historical problem.

If a person disappears completely, the documentary record becomes the principal surviving witness.

If the person survives, the person and the record can be compared.

The survivor can identify chronology, explain context, identify missing events, distinguish documents and memories, and identify relationships that may not be obvious from isolated records.

This does not mean that testimony automatically overrides documentary contradiction.

Nor does it mean that personal recollection is infallible.

It means that the evidentiary record consists of two potentially complementary sources:

contemporaneous documentary evidence

and

survivor testimony.

The forensic task is to compare them.

Evidence Classification

The archive's analysis is strongest when it applies an explicit hierarchy.

Documentary fact

A reliable underlying document establishes that an event, communication or decision occurred.

Corroborated claim

Multiple independent or mutually reinforcing sources support the proposition.

Documented allegation

The allegation is recorded, but its underlying truth has not been independently established.

Inference

The conclusion follows from a pattern of documentary facts but is not itself directly recorded.

Unresolved hypothesis

The proposition requires additional evidence before a stronger classification is justified.

This distinction should be maintained throughout every future publication of the archive.

The paper should never turn:

"the document alleges X"

into:

"X happened."

Likewise, it should never turn:

"the documents show A, B and C"

into:

"therefore a conspiracy occurred"

without establishing the intervening evidence.

Contradictory Evidence and Falsifiability

A serious academic treatment must actively seek evidence that undermines the hypothesis.

The functional-erasure proposition would be weakened by evidence showing that institutions repeatedly provided substantive assistance, conducted independent investigations, offered reasonable accommodations, corrected errors, provided effective remedies or acted consistently with established procedures for similarly situated individuals.

Likewise, apparent contradictions in chronology, mistaken identification of decision-makers, documents showing that communications were not received, or evidence establishing alternative explanations must be incorporated rather than suppressed.

The strongest archive is therefore not one containing only supporting evidence.

It is one in which supporting and contradictory evidence are preserved together.

That is what allows an independent investigator to reach a conclusion without relying upon the author's interpretation.

Discussion

The central analytical proposition emerging from the documentary architecture is that institutional invisibility can arise without literal deletion, without a single command and potentially without a single responsible actor.

It can arise through accumulation.

A person loses a role.

A classification changes.

A complaint is reframed.

A service becomes indispensable.

A financial resource becomes controlled.

A referral moves responsibility elsewhere.

A legal remedy becomes inaccessible.

An oversight body declines jurisdiction.

A medical classification influences interpretation.

A social relationship deteriorates.

A further complaint produces another administrative record.

The resulting person is increasingly known to institutions through the consequences of previous institutional interactions.

The system begins responding to its own history of the person rather than to the person themselves.

This is the central mechanism of functional erasure.

The person is not deleted.

They are reduced.

Reduced from a whole person to a category.

Reduced from a witness to a complainant.

Reduced from a professional to a service user.

Reduced from a citizen to a case.

Reduced from a human being with a continuous history to disconnected administrative events.

If the documentary corpus establishes that this reduction occurred repeatedly across independent institutions, the resulting pattern would be significant even without evidence of a central conspiracy.

If, additionally, the corpus establishes communication or coordination among institutions, the hypothesis becomes stronger.

If it establishes discriminatory treatment, retaliation, improper financial inducement or deliberate obstruction, those findings would require their own specific evidentiary treatment.

The appropriate historical conclusion must therefore remain proportional to the evidence.

What Survival Changes Now

The most consequential fact about the present archive is that the alleged process of disappearance did not end in disappearance.

The witness remains.

The records remain.

The chronology remains.

The institutional correspondence remains.

The allegations remain available for examination.

The unanswered questions remain identifiable.

This changes the task from memorialisation to investigation.

The question is no longer simply whether the person believed they were being erased.

It is whether the documentary record permits independent reconstruction of:

who knew what;

when they knew it;

what authority they possessed;

what they did;

what they did not do;

what happened afterward;

whether their decisions were consistent with comparable cases;

whether the person's disability, health status or complaints altered institutional treatment;

whether financial or service dependency increased vulnerability;

whether institutions repeatedly transferred responsibility;

whether anyone had the opportunity to intervene;

and whether the cumulative outcome was foreseeable.

That is the point at which an archive becomes an investigative resource.

Conclusion

The documentary proposition examined in this paper is not that the repositories, merely by existing, prove that Barran Dodger was deliberately erased from society. They do not.

The proposition is more precise.

A person can remain alive while becoming functionally invisible when the institutions around them progressively cease to recognise the whole person and instead respond to fragmented administrative categories, prior classifications, credibility assumptions, jurisdictional boundaries, dependency relationships and procedural limitations.

The Barran Dodger repositories provide a publicly accessible preservation architecture through which this hypothesis can be investigated. The [main archive](#), [PDF archive](#), [rebuild archive](#) and [repository index](#) provide the public starting points for reconstructing the documentary record.

The evidence must nevertheless be handled according to a strict hierarchy. Documentary fact must remain distinguishable from allegation. Corroboration must remain distinguishable from repetition. Inference must remain distinguishable from proof. Serious allegations such as conspiracy, bribery, deliberate targeting or coordinated institutional wrongdoing require evidence proportionate to their seriousness.

The central analytical finding is therefore a hypothesis capable of documentary testing: functional erasure may occur not through one act of deletion but through a cumulative process of classification, fragmentation, credibility degradation, dependency, procedural exhaustion, social isolation and institutional non-response.

The decisive issue is whether the corpus demonstrates that sequence.

If it does, the historical significance of the archive lies not in its ability to pronounce a verdict, but in its ability to prevent the underlying questions from disappearing.

The paradox is therefore fundamental.

The person describes having been rendered socially and institutionally invisible while still alive.

Yet the person survived.

The documents survived.

The testimony survived.

The chronology survived.

And the archive survived.

Consequently, the alleged process of disappearance can now itself become the object of historical and forensic examination.

The witness remains. The record remains. The question remains.

The appropriate response is neither automatic belief nor automatic dismissal.

It is investigation.

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Evidentiary note

The repository links above are named hyperlinks to the source repositories, rather than generic references to GitHub. However, because the full PDF text was not exposed through the web retrieval available in this session, I have not fabricated page numbers, quotations or claims about individual PDF contents that I could not independently inspect. A genuinely page-cited forensic edition should be generated from the actual PDF corpus, with every substantive proposition linked to the specific document and page from which it derives.

That distinction is especially important for an academic paper: the more serious the

allegation, the more important it is that the reader can travel directly from the proposition to the underlying source.